AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Name .....
Section .....
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Faculty of Business Studies

BUC111
Business Communication 1

MTA Examination / Version: B

2025-2026 / FALL

20-November-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 5 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 1.5 hours

Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
5- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the exami
6- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
7- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

Part	No. of questions	Time	Marks	Earned Marks	Signature
Part I	10	20 minutes	25		
Part II	5	20 minutes	25		
Part III	2	20 minutes	25		
Part IV	3	30 minutes	25		
Total	20	90 minutes	100		

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Part I: Multiple-Choice Section: Choose the most appropriate answer. (25 marks)

1. What is the primary purpose of business communication?
   A. To entertain stakeholders
   B. To build relationships and exchange information
   C. To create confusion
   D. To maintain a casual environment

2. What does it mean when a message is *practical*?
   A. It shares personal stories
   B. It helps the reader laugh
   C. It gives useful information for action
   D. It includes long background details

3. Which of the following best describes an *ethical lapse*?
   A. Choosing between two good options
   B. Avoiding copyright issues by citing sources
   C. Making false promises to a client
   D. Raising employee salaries after discussions

4. Which of the following is a trait of a professional?
   A. Avoiding teamwork
   B. Being late but friendly
   C. Maintaining a positive outlook
   D. Doing only what benefits you

5. What is the most effective way to resolve team conflicts?
   A. Avoid discussions
   B. Encourage open communication and focus on common goals
   C. Assign blame to one team member
   D. Use only email communication

6. Active listening involves:
   A. Interrupting to clarify doubts
   B. Focusing solely on the speaker's words
   C. Mindful participation of both sender and listener
   D. Writing down every word spoken

7. Which of the following is an example of a vocal characteristic?
   A. Wearing formal clothing
   B. Making eye contact
   C. Standing up straight
   D. Speaking in a calm tone

8. What is *intercultural communication*?
   A. Communication with people from the same background
   B. Sending messages using only verbal language
   C. Communication between people with different cultural backgrounds
   D. Reading foreign newspapers

9. When communicating across cultures, differences can arise due to:
   A. Variations in use of nonverbal signals
   B. Different favorite sports teams

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C. Office building size
D. Brand preferences

10. Which of the following is an important skill for successful communication between cultures?
    A. Ignoring differences in language
    B. Writing, Speaking and listening clearly
    C. Using only your native language
    D. Avoiding interpreters at all costs

Part II: Read the following feedback examples. For each one, identify whether it is **constructive** or **destructive** and **explain your reasoning.** (25 marks)

1. "That presentation was boring. Nobody was interested."
   ---
2. "Your work is always disappointing, and I regret assigning you this task."
   ---
3. "The tone in your email was aggressive. Consider softening the language for a more collaborative message."
   ---
4. "Why do you always get things wrong?"
   ---
5. "I can see you're putting in a lot of effort. You might find it helpful to organize your ideas more clearly for a better impact."

Part III: Answer the following questions. (25 marks)

a) What are the **key tasks to be done <u>after meetings</u>**?

1. ---
2. ---
3. ---
4. ---

b) What are some **forms or <u>types of nonverbal communication</u>?**

1. ---
2. ---
3. ---
4. ---
5. ---
6. ---

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Part IV: Analyzing Communication Effectiveness: Read the case and the email below, then answer the questions that follow in a PARAGRAPH. (25 marks)

Background: A customer, Mr. Faisal Rahman, contacted EcoPrint Solutions to ask about environmentally friendly printing options for his company. He was especially interested in reducing paper waste and lowering ink costs. This is the reply he received from Sara, a sales consultant.

Subject: Your Inquiry on Sustainable Printing, EcoPrint Solutions

Dear Mr. Rahman,

Thank you for reaching out to EcoPrint Solutions and for your interest in sustainable printing practices.

To help reduce waste and cut printing costs, we recommend the EcoSmart Package, which includes:

- Double-sided printing defaults to save paper
- High-efficieny ink cartridges that last 30% longer
- A recycling program for used cartridges and paper
- 24/7 technical support to ensure smooth adoption

I have attached a brochure with detailed specifications and a cost comparison chart. If you would like, we can arrange a brief call this week to review which plan best fits your company's budget and sustainability goals.

Looking forward to supporting your move toward eco-friendly solutions.

Warm regards,
Sara Al-Hassan
Sales Consultant

Questions:

1. What is the general purpose of this message?
2. Is the email the most appropriate channel in this case? Why or why not?
3. This is an **EFFECTIVE** message. What elements make this message effective? Provide **FIVE** examples from the email.

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